

1.9 User Interface Design (UI vs UX)

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CS XII

Chapter 1: Computer Systems (HCI)

Lecture 12 of 16

★ Golden

1.9 User Interface Design (UI vs UX) ★ Golden

LEARN IT

UI design is the process of creating and organizing the **visual elements** of a software application so users can interact with it easily and efficiently.

1.9.1 Components of a user interface

Component	Role
Buttons	Clickable elements that perform actions (Submit, Cancel).
Menus	Lists of options for navigating the system.
Icons	Small symbols representing tools or actions.
Text fields	Boxes where users type information (passwords, search).
Checkboxes / radio buttons	Selecting options in a form. Checkboxes allow several choices; radio buttons allow only one in a group.
Sliders	Adjusting values along a bar (volume, brightness).

1.9.2 User experience (UX)

UX is the overall experience a user has while interacting with a system — how smooth, comfortable and satisfying it feels.

UI is what you see; UX is how it feels.

WORKED EXAMPLE

Source example: food-delivery app. The UI is the nice pictures of burgers and the red buttons. The UX is that the app loads fast, tracking works, and the food arrives without the user getting frustrated.

Local walk-through: JazzCash.

- **UI:** green Send button, JazzCash logo, amount text field, fingerprint icon, menu of Bill / Load / Send.
- **UX:** login in two seconds, no crash in a weak-signal bazaar, money arrives, SMS comes, the user feels safe and finished — or, if it hangs with no tick, the UX is bad even if the buttons look pretty.

School portal: UI = logo, "Login" button, date-sheet menu icon. UX = a student finds the chemistry practical date in under a minute on a phone, without calling the clerk.

Pretty UI + slow, confusing flow = poor UX. Plain UI + fast, clear flow = good UX.

REMEMBER IT

Clothes vs day out. UI is the outfit (colours, buttons, icons). UX is the whole day (Did you arrive on time? Did you get wet? Were you stressed?). Examiners love the line: *UI is what you see; UX is how it feels.*

COMMON MISTAKE

Mistake: Writing "UI and UX are the same" or "UX is just colours".

Fix: UI = visual components (buttons, menus, icons, fields, checkboxes, sliders). UX = overall smoothness, comfort and satisfaction, including speed and whether the task succeeds.

اردو میں سمجھیں

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EXAM TIP

Highest-yield short question in the chapter: "Differentiate between UI and UX with an example."
Write: (1) the two definitions, (2) the sentence "UI is what you see; UX is how it feels", (3) the food-delivery example from the source, (4) optionally JazzCash or the school portal. For 5 marks also list four UI components. Do not spend the answer describing Figma — that is the next topic.

CHECK YOURSELF

1. List six UI components from the source.
2. In the food-delivery example, what is UX?
3. Complete: "UI is what you see; UX is ____."

Answers: 1. Buttons, menus, icons, text fields, checkboxes/radio buttons, sliders. 2. The app loads fast, tracking works, food arrives without frustration. 3. how it feels.

Next lecture: 1.9.3–1.9.5 Wireframing, Figma and Prototypes